The 6:15

SUNDAY · OCTOBER 11, 2026 NO. 25

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · WEEKEND EDITION, CONDENSED

Next 5 days	Tue 10/13: Wells Fargo (confirmed, 7a ET), JPMorgan, Citigroup and Goldman Sachs all expected to open Q3 bank earnings **(JPM/GS/C dates not yet formally confirmed by the companies; per-share consensus for GS ranges $13.33–$15.62 and for C $2.59–$2.67 depending on the aggregator — flagged, not a wire survey; only WFC's $1.88 estimate holds steady across sources)**. Wed 10/14, 8:30a ET: September CPI, street consensus ~3.7% headline / 2.4% core, Cleveland Fed nowcast (Oct. 7) 3.60%/2.39% **(secondary-source consensus, not a wire survey)**.
Standing	FOMC Oct. 27–28; OPEC+ next meets Nov. 1 (November output already held flat at 31.01mn b/d, decided Oct. 4 **(continuity)**); Dec. 11 CR funding deadline and Jan. 10 US-China truce unchanged **(continuity)**; no frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or VC mega-round verified this run — fourth straight issue skipping this sub-bullet rather than padding it.

METRICS · WEEKEND EDITION, CONDENSED — ALL FRI. 10/9 CLOSES, MARKETS SHUT THROUGH MON.

Oil / rates / dollar	Brent $104.72 (+0.42%) / WTI $91.85 (+0.39%), spread ~$12.9, 4:59p ET settle **(Yahoo's detail panel separately lists a $91.49 WTI print — discrepancy still not resolved)**; 10Y 5.24% (+0.01) / 30Y 5.60% (-0.01) / 13-wk bill 4.057% **(no 2Y quote located this run — third consecutive run)**; DXY 102.23 (+0.02%).
Equities / vol / gold / gas / overseas	S&P 500 7,811.54 (+0.59%), Nasdaq Composite 27,366.17 (+0.64%), VIX 14.84 (-3.70%), gold (Dec. future) $4,216.30 (+1.43%) — all Fri. 10/9 closes.

	Asia/Europe (also Fri. 10/9 closes): Nikkei 69,030.92 (-0.02%), Hang Seng 24,211.35 (+1.79%), FTSE 100 10,552.05 (+1.06%), DAX 25,087.27 (+1.13%). AAA national retail gas $4.3585/gal today, down from $4.3669 Friday.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Status	Strait "closed" to commercial shipping per war-risk insurers, day 224 of closure framing (straits.live); CENTCOM's own enforcement blockade (separate from Iranian strikes) has turned back 135 vessels and disabled 4 since resuming July 14 **(CENTCOM, via The National — supersedes Middle East Eye's single-sourced 133 figure used in issue No. 24)**.
Transits	4 on Oct. 4 vs. 85/day pre-crisis baseline (IMF PortWatch, via straits.live) **(unchanged, now about a week stale)**. Separately, AIS-dark tanker count 56 of 139 screened in the past 24h vs. a 7-day baseline of 89.3 (straits.live) **(a floor, not a measure of deliberate evasion, per the site's own caveat)**.
Strikes	At least 12 attack/harassment incidents Sept. 28–Oct. 5, the highest weekly total since the war began Feb. 28 (UKMTO, via Euronews). Weekend wave, all [NEW]: IRGC claims it hit the engine room of tanker MV Sun Shine Oct. 9; IRGC/ISNA/Fars claim an unnamed supertanker struck a mine Oct. 10 **(unverified independently)**; UKMTO separately logged an outbound tanker hit by a projectile near the strait Oct. 10 and flagged a Gulf of Oman tanker/military incident with no detail yet; UAE National Guard rescued 22 crew from a burning tanker in the Arabian Gulf. A US fighter jet struck the Panama-flagged Ocean Molika ("Arika Sun") Oct. 10 for breaching the blockade — the first reported case this run of the US itself striking a vessel, per CENTCOM; no crew harmed.
War-risk / scores	Up to $10.0M per VLCC transit, ~30x pre-crisis **(dated 27 Jul 2026, unchanged for roughly 2½ months)**. Crisis Pressure 88/100 "extreme" (unchanged); Escalation Forecast 61/100 "high," up

	from 60 in issue No. 24, now 3-of-4 inputs reporting, Brent-WTI forward spread still the top driver.

Methodology: PortWatch transit counts (lagged by design), UKMTO/press incident counts, CENTCOM's own blockade-enforcement tally, and straits.live's derived indices each measure a different thing over a different window and are never averaged or differenced in this brief. All straits.live figures and the IRGC's mine-strike and MV Sun Shine claims are single-sourced/unverified independently.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over — eliminated Oct. 7, swept 3-0 by the Rays in the ALDS **(continuity)**.
Knicks	Still 0-2 in the preseason; no game since issue No. 24. Next up: Mon. 10/12 vs. Minnesota at MSG.
Northwestern	[NEW] Beat Ball State 45-14 Saturday at Ryan Field, Homecoming; now 4-1 overall, 1-1 Big Ten.

LEAD

IRAN · HORMUZ · ESCALATION

For the first time, a US jet fires on a vessel to enforce its own Hormuz blockade — as Iran's own attacks hit a wartime-high weekly pace and spread region-wide

US Central Command said a US fighter jet struck the stern of the Panama-flagged cargo ship Ocean Molika, known also as the Arika Sun, with a "precision munition" on Saturday, after the vessel left an Iranian port and tried to transit regional waters in defiance of the US naval blockade; CENTCOM said the crew had ignored repeated warnings and that no one was harmed. [NEW, fact, CENTCOM via The National] It is the fourth commercial vessel CENTCOM says it has disabled, and the 135th it says it has turned back, since the blockade was resumed July 14 — but it is the first of those four disablements reported this run, meaning the run of recent CENTCOM enforcement has escalated from interdiction (turning

ships around, clearing mines) to direct kinetic force against a civilian-flagged hull. [fact]

That US strike landed in the middle of Iran's own highest-tempo week of the war: UKMTO counted at least 12 attack or harassment incidents on tankers between Sept. 28 and Oct. 5, the worst week since the war began Feb. 28. [fact] After the IRGC said Friday it had hit the engine room of the tanker MV Sun Shine for taking an "unauthorized route," it explicitly widened its stated targeting doctrine: strikes would no longer be confined to the strait, violating vessels would be pursued "anywhere in the region," and companies accused of cooperating with Washington would have all their ships targeted. [NEW, fact] Saturday added a mine claim (IRGC/ISNA/Fars, an unnamed supertanker, unverified independently), a separate UKMTO-logged projectile strike on an outbound tanker near the strait, an unspecified Gulf of Oman "tanker/military" incident UKMTO flagged without detail, and a fire aboard a tanker in the Arabian Gulf from which the UAE National Guard rescued 22 crew. [NEW, fact/flag]

Read: this doesn't reverse Trump's Wednesday pledge not to strike Iran itself before Nov. 3 (issue No. 24) — that promise was specifically about offensive action against Iranian territory, and the blockade was explicitly carved out as continuing. But the distinction the investor should hold onto is that the blockade's own enforcement just got more lethal on the US side, in the same week Iran's attack tempo hit a wartime high and its stated rules of engagement went region-wide rather than strait-only. Both escalation tracks are now moving at once, independent of whether Washington strikes Tehran before the midterms. [read]

None of this has a market price yet. Friday's closes (Brent +0.42%, WTI +0.39%, VIX down to 14.84) predate Saturday's strike and claims entirely, and US, European and Asian markets are shut through Monday — so Monday's open is the first point at which any of this weekend's news, plus the already-stale, unmoved $10.0M war-risk premium cited on the Board, gets a chance to be priced at all. [read] That open also doubles as the start of a week carrying four bank earnings reports and Wednesday's CPI print, which will be competing for the market's attention against a maritime story that just added a new actor — the US Navy itself — to the list of parties using force in the strait. Watch: whether CENTCOM's strike on Ocean Molika is a one-off or the start of a pattern; whether Iran follows through on region-wide targeting beyond the strait; and how Monday's open treats a weekend of escalation that had no trading session to react to it.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the Lead, the MV Sun Shine strike carries detail worth separating out: Iran's IRGC Navy said the tanker is linked to the shipping firm Natwit, and that the vessel used a route through the strait's southern section that Tehran considers unauthorized before the engine-room and propulsion hit set it ablaze. [NEW, fact] Hojjatoleslam Mohammad Javad Ali-Akbari, Tehran's Friday prayer leader, used the same day to say the strait would stay closed until Iran's seven conditions are met and that Iran's posture had shifted "from defence to offence" — rhetoric that lines up with the IRGC's region-wide targeting language rather than contradicting it. [NEW, fact] CENTCOM's competing account, issued the same day, says US forces have cleared the main shipping lanes, removed naval mines, and reopened them to vessels not violating US sanctions on Iran, and

that thousands of commercial ships have transited safely under that arrangement — a framing hard to reconcile with straits.live's "closed, day 224" status line on the Board, and this brief does not try to adjudicate between the two. [fact/flag]

Earlier in the week, before Saturday's cluster, UKMTO had already logged an LPG carrier struck by unknown projectiles roughly 13 nautical miles west of Al-Jazira, UAE, on Friday (fire brought under control), and a Thursday strike on an oil tanker north of Qatari waters that caused casualties, with Vanguard separately reporting a probable fire aboard the Marshall Islands-flagged Dalkut about 40km off Fujairah. [NEW, fact] None of these three carried a confirmed casualty count in the sourcing available this run, and the Thursday incident's casualty figure specifically is flagged as unconfirmed pending a fuller UKMTO or P&I-club writeup. [flag]

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over — eliminated Oct. 7 in the ALDS.
Knicks	0-2 preseason; next game Mon. 10/12 vs. Minnesota at MSG.
Northwestern	Beat Ball State 45-14 Saturday; now 4-1 overall, 1-1 Big Ten.

Continuity. Weekend edition: Metrics and Calendar condensed per the standing weekend rule; Politics, Economics, Business and Technology cut entirely — nothing moved since issue No. 24 outside the Hormuz/blockade story and the bank-earnings/CPI calendar already carried above, and no frontier-AI release, rocket launch or VC mega-round was verified this run, fourth issue running. The Northwestern and Knicks threads flagged as pending in No. 24 are resolved (Northwestern) or carried forward unchanged (Knicks, no game played) here. Watch for next issue: whether the Ocean Molika strike repeats; Iran's region-wide targeting follow-through; Monday's market open pricing the weekend's news for the first time; Tuesday's bank earnings and Wednesday's CPI.

Unverified figures are marked in red above. Single-sourced or otherwise flagged this issue: the IRGC's MV Sun Shine and Oct. 10 mine-strike claims; the Gulf of Oman incident UKMTO flagged without detail; the Thursday Qatari-waters casualty count; CENTCOM's "cleared

lanes" counter-narrative to the "closed" status line; all straits.live Hormuz figures (status framing, Crisis Pressure/Escalation Forecast scores, dark-tanker count, war-risk premium); GS/Citi earnings consensus (aggregators disagree). WTI's headline $91.85 and detail-panel $91.49 are not reconciled. No 2-year Treasury quote was located this run, the third consecutive issue without one. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.